A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

22 April 2026

Dr Pritinesh Singh
Parkside Specialists

Dear Dr Singh,

Re: Mr James Russo
DOB: 1991-12-10
Address: 502/9 Darling Street, SOUTH YARRA, VIC, 3141

Summary

- **Idiopathic small intestinal ulcers with normal histology and normal faecal calprotectin.**
- **Normal intestinal ultrasound excluding active inflammatory bowel disease.**
- **Symptomatic presentation consistent with food sensitivity and flushing.**
- **Trial of high-dose loratadine for symptomatic control.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of conducting a review with James Russo to discuss the results of his recent investigations. As you are aware, his index colonoscopy identified small intestinal ulcers, though the associated biopsies were histologically normal. Subsequent investigations, including an intestinal ultrasound and a faecal calprotectin, have returned unremarkable results with no evidence of significant inflammation.

At this stage, the clinical significance of these ulcers remains uncertain. In many instances, such findings are idiopathic and either remain stable or resolve spontaneously without evolving into a formal diagnosis of Crohn's disease. I have reassured James that his current symptoms appear to be independent of these endoscopic findings.

James continues to experience significant symptoms triggered by specific foods, particularly those high in fat, MSG, or seasonings, such as calamari and avocado. These episodes are characterised by prominent facial flushing, a sensation of intense heat, bloating, and occasional loose stools. He also noted systemic symptoms, including reduced concentration and a flare of his scalp folliculitis

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065

A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

following these dietary triggers. He is currently managing the folliculitis with a low-dose course of Roaccutane.

Impression and Plan

James already manages his symptoms well through dietary modification. Given the nature of his flushing and the rapid onset of symptoms, I suspect a histamine-mediated sensitivity or a variant of chronic urticaria. I have recommended a trial of loratadine 10mg, which can be taken up to three or four times daily as required. This may be used reactively at the onset of symptoms or pre-emptively when he expects to consume trigger foods in social or professional settings.

We discussed the option of using nortriptyline to blunt these food-related reactions; however, James is currently comfortable managing his condition without daily neuromodulators. I have advised him that his symptoms do not indicate ongoing intestinal damage. We will move forward with a conservative approach for now. I have suggested a repeat surveillance colonoscopy in approximately 12 months to ensure there is no progression of the previously noted ulcers. I will review him sooner should his symptoms escalate or his dietary restrictions become burdensome.

Yours sincerely,

A/Prof Chamara Basnayake
Gastroenterologist

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065